



Aiding Exports

Outside Korea, India is Hyundai Motor India's largest export base

BY KARAN DHAR

FOR NEARLY THREE decades, Hyundai Motor India Ltd's sprawling manufacturing facility in Sriperumbudur, Chennai, stood as a formidable bastion of the South Korean automaker, driving its growth in one of the world's fastest-growing automotive markets. Now, with the acquisition of General Motors' Talegaon plant in Pune, Hyundai is embarking on a capacity expansion drive to deepen its manufacturing footprint in the country.

"The Pune plant is not only for capacity fulfilment. It is much more than that. It helps us in geography, exports, scale and de-risking," Tarun Garg, the managing director and CEO of Hyundai Motor India, tells BT in an interview. "We wanted to expand as both domestic and export demand is going up. As a manufacturing hub, Pune already has a supplier ecosystem. The GM plant was available for us to take," Garg adds.

The Pune plant, where operations commenced in 2025, will have a capacity of 170,000 vehicles starting in October. "We are moving to a capacity of 250,000 units by 2028, and we would be reaching 300,000 by 2030," says Garg, adding that Pune gives Hyundai a geographical advantage as the western region is the carmaker's biggest market. Meanwhile, Hyundai's Chennai plant can produce up to 824,000 vehicles annually.

The South Korean carmaker is doubling down on its investments in India. "In the past 30 years, we invested about ₹40,000 crore. But in the next five years, we have already planned a ₹45,000 crore investment in India. This shows a big thrust on India," says Garg. Most of this investment will go into capacity expansion.

Hyundai produced 769,280 cars and SUVs in the financial year 2025-26, retaining its position as India's second-largest car producer by volume. It accounted for 21% of passenger vehicle exports from India in the financial year 2025-26.

"We are the No. 2 domestic-plus-export OEM in India. We have no plans to give it up. The next phase of our strategy is new model introductions. We have already announced 26 models from FY26 to FY30, including re-

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freshes and upgrades," says Garg. By 2030, Hyundai is going to have five to six CNG models, five to six hybrids and four to five electric vehicles, says Garg.

India's importance in Hyundai Motor Company's scheme of things is only increasing, according to Garg. In FY26, Hyundai exported 190,125 vehicles. Outside Korea, India is Hyundai's largest export base. "It can play a much larger role," says Garg. "Going forward, we are looking to leverage FTAs which the government has signed and looking at opportunities to expand our export footprint beyond emerging markets." **BT**

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